

Muscle Gain Guide

Core Principle

Muscle growth (hypertrophy) requires progressive mechanical tension over time plus adequate recovery resources - primarily protein and total calories.

A modest calorie surplus (~200-300 kcal/day above TDEE) supports growth while limiting excess fat gain; very large surpluses mostly add fat, not muscle.

Training Variables for Hypertrophy

Variable	Typical Guidance
Rep Range	6-15 reps per set works well; effort/proximity to failure matters more than exact rep count
Weekly Volume	10-20 sets per muscle group per week for most trainees
Frequency	Training each muscle group 2x/week generally outperforms 1x/week at equal volume
Proximity to Failure	Training within 1-3 reps of failure most sets drives strong hypertrophy signal
Rest Between Sets	60-90s for isolation work, 2-3 min for heavy compounds

Nutrition for Growth

Protein: 1.6-2.2 g/kg bodyweight per day, spread across 3-5 meals.

Carbohydrates fuel training performance and recovery - do not cut them aggressively while trying to build muscle.

Consistency across weeks matters more than any single 'anabolic window' - total daily protein and calories are the primary drivers.

Tracking Progress

Track lifts (weight x reps) over time - strength trending upward at a stable or slowly increasing bodyweight is a strong sign of muscle gain.

Progress photos and circumference measurements (arms, chest, waist, thighs) every 2-4 weeks complement the scale, which is noisy day to day.